

# Usui Holy Fire® III

## Reiki Level I Training

Led by Kate Gajewski

A foundational training in Reiki, energy anatomy, and  
hands-on healing practice.

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# A calm foundation for learning Reiki.

This Reiki Level I training offers a grounded introduction to Reiki, energy anatomy, self-treatment, and treatment for others. The intention of this course is to help students understand Reiki as both a healing modality and a personal spiritual practice.

## In This Training

- What Reiki is
- What Reiki may feel like
- A simple science perspective
- The Reiki ideals
- The history of Reiki
- Energy anatomy: chakras, aura, meridians
- Grounding and shielding
- Ocean of Holy Love experience
- The Three Heavens
- Reiki I placement
- Gassho, Reiji-ho, and session flow
- Self-treatment and treatment for others

## Course Materials

### **Primary text:**

*Reiki: The Healing Touch, First and Second Degree Manual* by William Lee Rand

### **Additional notes and teaching guidance:**

Kate Gajewski

# What is Reiki?

Reiki is spiritually guided life force energy. It supports relaxation, restoration, and healing by helping the body return to a more balanced state.

**Rei** means spiritual wisdom.

**Ki** means life force energy.

Reiki may support the physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual bodies depending on what the receiver is ready to process. It is not a replacement for medical care, but it can complement many forms of healing and recovery.

## What Reiki May Feel Like

Every person experiences Reiki differently, and no two sessions are exactly the same.

- warmth or cooling sensations
- tingling
- swirling or pulsing
- heaviness or lightness
- deep relaxation
- emotional release
- a peaceful, trance-like state

Some people feel very little during the session and notice the effects later. Openness, nervous system state, and personal sensitivity can all shape the experience.

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Reiki is most deeply understood through direct experience as much as study.

# How Reiki works.

Reiki is guided by spiritual intelligence and by the wisdom of the energy itself.

The practitioner does not force the healing. Rather, the practitioner offers a clear channel through which Reiki can move where it is most needed. The hands may help direct attention, but the energy itself flows according to the highest good of the receiver.

## A Simple Science Perspective

Studies suggest that Reiki may support the parasympathetic nervous system, the body's "rest and digest" state. This can help the body relax, restore, and repair while supporting a decrease in stress response.

Reiki may also be understood through the body's connective tissue and energetic communication systems. While science continues to explore these mechanisms, Reiki is most deeply understood through direct experience.

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Supporting articles: [pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5871310](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5871310/), [pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/15674004](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/15674004/), and [rheumatologyadvisor.com/news/reiki-and-hand-massage-reduce-pain-fatigue-in-rheumatoid-arthritis/](https://rheumatologyadvisor.com/news/reiki-and-hand-massage-reduce-pain-fatigue-in-rheumatoid-arthritis/)

# The ideals and history of Reiki.

Reiki is both a healing practice and a lineage of wisdom passed through tradition, prayer, and experience.

## The Reiki Ideals

Just for today:

Do not be angry

Do not worry

Be filled with gratitude

Devote yourself to your work

Be kind to people

These ideals are not only philosophical. They are part of the living practice of Reiki and support healing in everyday life.

## The History of Reiki

Reiki originates in Japan through the teachings of Mikao Usui. Over time, Reiki has evolved through different lineages and teaching styles while remaining rooted in healing, spiritual development, and compassionate service.

Usui Holy Fire III Reiki is part of a modern lineage that honors the traditional system while also including updated spiritual experiences and placements.

# Understanding the energetic body.

Energy anatomy offers a way of understanding how life force moves through and around the body.

Reiki practitioners often work with several energetic systems at once, including chakras, the aura, and meridians. This framework helps us notice where energy may feel strong, stagnant, depleted, or ready to release.

## The Aura

The aura is the energetic field that surrounds the body. It is dynamic, responsive, and always changing. In Reiki practice, the aura can be sensed, soothed, cleared, and strengthened.



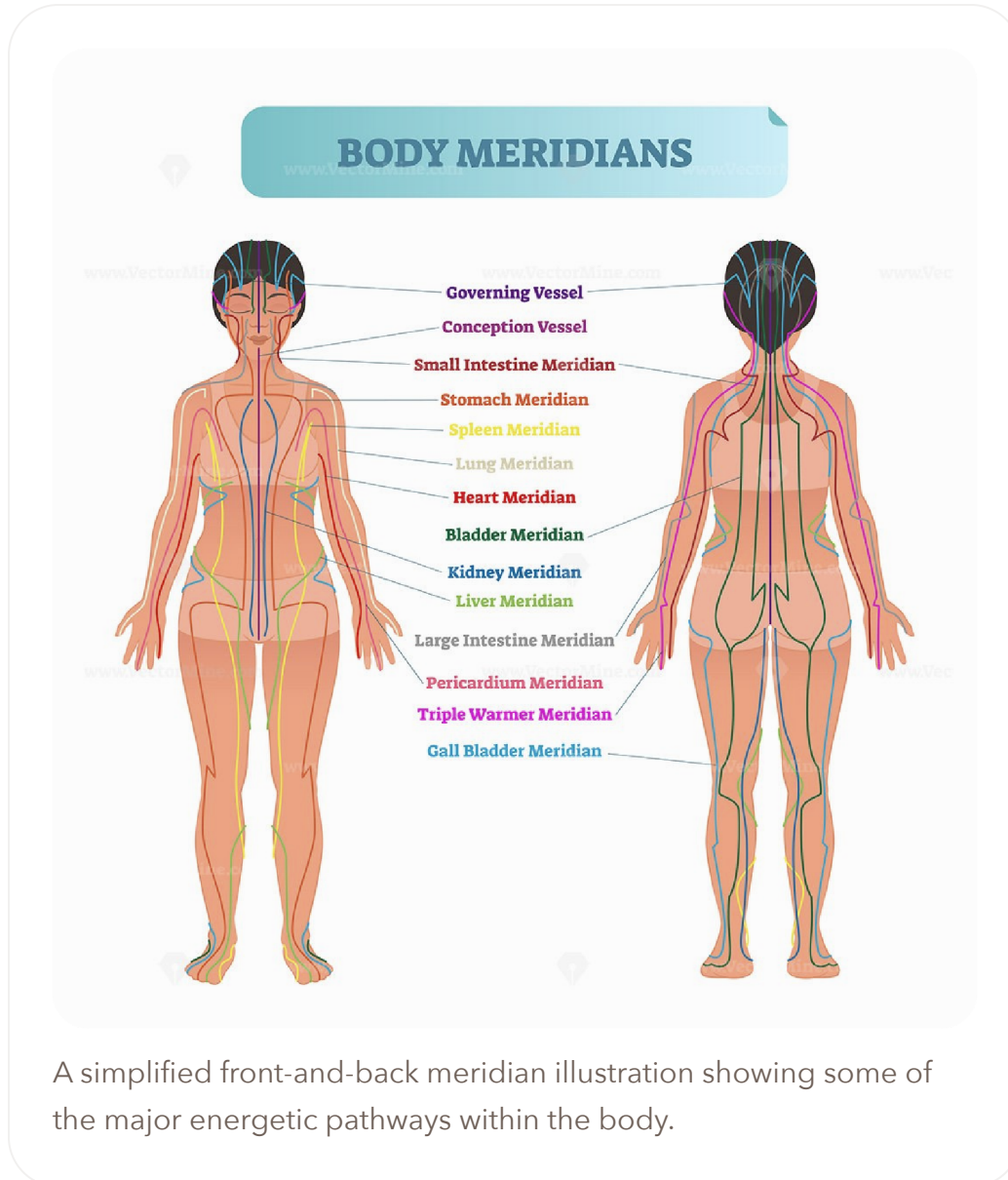
A visual representation of the aura as a layered energetic field extending beyond the physical body.

# Meridians and energetic pathways.

Meridians are often described as the body's energetic pathways or "energy highways."

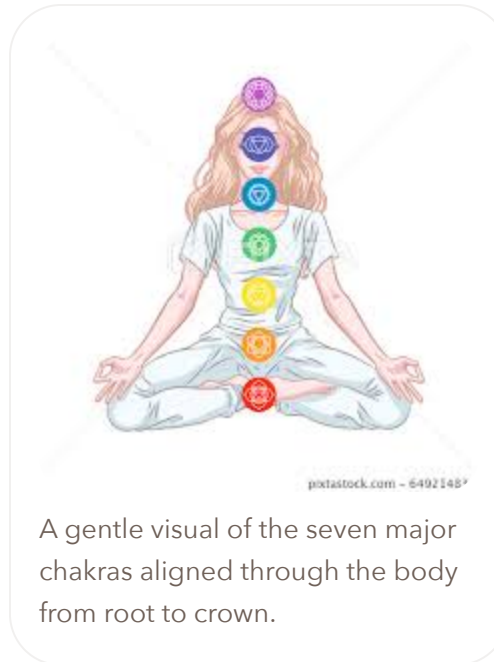
## Meridians

Meridians are often described as the body's energetic pathways or "energy highways." The chakras help regulate energy flow, and this movement supports circulation through the meridian system and the energetic field around the body.



# The seven primary energy centers.

The chakras are often described as spinning wheels of energy that receive, regulate, and circulate life force through the body.



A gentle visual of the seven major chakras aligned through the body from root to crown.

## Root Chakra

Muladhara • base of spine • safety, grounding, stability

When balanced, the root chakra supports steadiness, trust, and resilience. When imbalanced, it may show up as fear, insecurity, instability, or survival stress.

## Sacral Chakra

Svadhithana • below the navel • creativity, pleasure, emotional flow

When balanced, the sacral chakra supports joy, creative movement, emotional expression, and connection. When imbalanced, it may show up as creative blocks, emotional instability, numbness, or difficulty receiving pleasure.

## Solar Plexus Chakra

Manipura • above the navel • confidence, willpower, healthy boundaries

When balanced, the solar plexus supports clarity, confidence, and healthy self-respect. When imbalanced, it may show up as low self-worth, indecision, passivity, or overcontrol.



## Heart Chakra

Anahata • center of chest • love, compassion, forgiveness

When balanced, the heart chakra supports connection, trust, and emotional healing. When imbalanced, it may show up as grief, guardedness, difficulty receiving love, or relational pain.

## Throat Chakra

Vishuddha • throat • truth, expression, communication

When balanced, the throat chakra supports clear and honest communication. When imbalanced, it may show up as fear of speaking, creative blockage, dishonesty, or feeling unheard.

## Third Eye Chakra

Ajna • brow center • intuition, clarity, inner guidance

When balanced, the third eye supports intuitive knowing, trust, and inner vision. When imbalanced, it may show up as confusion, disconnection from intuition, or overthinking.

## Crown Chakra

Sahasrara • crown of head • spirituality, unity, higher wisdom

When balanced, the crown chakra supports peace, meaning, and spiritual connection. When imbalanced, it may show up as disconnection, confusion, or spiritual rigidity.

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Each chakra has both a front and back aspect, which is one reason Reiki may be offered to both the front and back of the body during a session.

# Grounding and shielding.

Before offering Reiki, it is important to become a stable, clear, and protected channel for healing.

## Grounding

- Grounding cord and coil visualization
- Imagining roots growing into the earth
- Feeling both feet firmly planted
- Noticing whether the body feels balanced and supported

## Shielding

- Surrounding yourself with white light
- The rose visualization
- Visualizing a suit of armor
- Palo Santo, sage, or selenite for clearing

# Opening the session with intention.

Once the body is grounded and the field is clear, the session can begin with prayer, focus, and intuitive guidance.

## Gassho Meditation

Gassho means “two hands coming together.” It helps bring attention to the heart and palm chakras while softening ego and returning the practitioner to presence.

“I ask for this healing for \_\_\_\_\_, for their highest good, in the softest and gentlest of ways. I give thanks in advance for the blessings to be received and ask that I be used as a clear channel for this healing, putting all ego and personality aside.”

## Reiji-ho

Reiji-ho means “indication of the spirit.” This prayer invites intuition to guide the session and reveal where Reiki is most needed.

“I ask my intuition to guide me in this healing and provide any information that may be needed for the highest good of \_\_\_\_\_.”

# Before, during, and after Reiki.

## Before the Session

- Wash your hands
- Ground and shield yourself
- Say the Gassho prayer
- Say the Reiji-ho prayer
- Perform a body scan
- Begin the Reiki session

## After the Session

- Seal the healing
- Offer a closing prayer
- Brush down the client's aura
- Practice Kenyoku, or dry bathing
- Let the client know the session is complete
- Wash your hands

## After Reiki Level I Certification

- Practice Reiki on yourself daily
- Offer Reiki to willing friends, family, and clients
- Continue receiving Reiki from others
- Work with the Reiki ideals in daily life
- Release rigid expectations and trust the practice
- Journal your experiences and questions

# Suggested treatment positions.

These placements offer a simple foundation for both self-treatment and sessions with others.

## Self-Treatment

- top of head
- forehead / third eye
- one hand on each ear
- base of skull
- throat
- shoulders
- heart center
- solar plexus
- sacral area
- hips / root
- lower back
- feet

## Treating Others

### Front of body

- top of head
- forehead, hovering when needed
- one hand on each ear
- base of skull
- neck, hovering when needed
- shoulders
- heart center
- solar plexus
- sacral area
- hips / root
- knees
- feet

### Back of body

- top of head
- shoulders
- upper back
- middle back
- lower back
- base of spine / hips
- feet

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Reiki is both a practice and a relationship. The more gently, consistently, and reverently you work with it, the more clearly you will come to understand it.